

Cirque Corporation

Patch Management Policy

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1. Introduction

Timely application of security patches is critical to protecting Cirque Corporation systems from known vulnerabilities and cyber threats.

2. Purpose

This policy establishes requirements for identifying, testing, approving, and deploying security patches and updates to operating systems, applications, firmware, and network devices.

3. Scope

This policy applies to all servers, workstations, network devices, applications, and systems operated by or on behalf of Cirque Corporation.

4. Patch Sources

Security patches shall be obtained from:

- Operating system vendors (Microsoft, Linux distributions, etc.)
- Application vendors and publishers
- Hardware and firmware manufacturers
- Security advisories and threat intelligence feeds
- Vulnerability scanning tool recommendations

5. Patch Assessment

Upon release, patches shall be assessed for:

- Criticality and severity of vulnerability addressed
- Applicability to Cirque systems
- Dependencies and compatibility requirements
- Potential business impact
- Vendor recommendations and deployment timeline

6. Patch Testing

Before production deployment, patches shall be:

- Tested in non-production environment
- Validated for compatibility with existing systems
- Assessed for performance impact
- Documented with test results

Critical security patches may have abbreviated testing when urgent deployment is needed.

7. Patch Deployment Schedule

Patches shall be deployed according to severity:

- Critical: Within 7 days of release (or immediately if actively exploited)
- High: Within 30 days of release
- Medium: Within 60 days of release
- Low: Within 90 days or with next scheduled maintenance

Automated patching should be used where feasible for critical infrastructure.

8. Automatic Patching

Critical systems may be configured for automatic patch installation:

- Server operating systems: Automatic installation of critical security patches
- Workstations: Automatic updates enabled for OS and antivirus
- Network devices: Scheduled automated updates where supported
- Monitoring to verify successful installation

9. Manual Patching

Systems requiring manual patching:

- Legacy systems with compatibility concerns
- Production systems requiring change control approval
- Systems with custom configurations
- Third-party managed systems

Manual patching shall follow Change Management Policy procedures.

10. Emergency Patching

For zero-day vulnerabilities or actively exploited threats:

- Emergency change process may be invoked
- Patches deployed rapidly with abbreviated testing
- Rollback plan prepared before deployment
- Close monitoring during and after deployment
- Full documentation and post-deployment review

11. Patch Verification

After deployment, verify:

- Successful installation on all targeted systems
- No adverse impacts on system functionality
- Vulnerability scanner confirms patch applied
- Documentation updated with deployment status

12. Patch Documentation

Maintain records including:

- Patches evaluated and deployment decisions
- Systems patched and dates deployed
- Test results and approvals
- Failed deployments and remediation actions
- Compliance with deployment timelines

13. Exceptions

Patch deployment exceptions require:

- Documented justification
- Risk assessment and compensating controls
- Approval by IT Manager and CISO
- Re-evaluation at least quarterly

14. Roles and Responsibilities

- IT Team: Assess, test, and deploy patches
- System Owners: Approve patches for their systems
- IT Manager: Oversee patch management program
- CISO: Monitor compliance and approve exceptions